

100 Days of Azure DevOps

Day 75 Handout — A dashboard is a storyboard: up, erroring, spending — if it needs a TED talk it is a novel

8 - Monitoring & Observability · Personal lab only · Educational content · Not a sales pitch

Architecture A — dashboard vs workbook vs a pasted screenshot

Surface	What it is	Share / identity
Azure dashboard	Pinned tiles from real blades (App Insights, Cost, metrics)	Share with yourself only in this lab. Public = leak risk
Workbook	Narrative + parameters + queries. A runbook in portal form	Literacy today. Do not add chapters because the storyboard is already long
App Insights view	Failures / availability as source of pins	Pin the live chart, not a PNG of last Tuesday
Cost Management tile	Are we spending by accident?	Lab sparkline keeps the habit honest
ADO dashboard	Pipeline widgets — different product (Day 76 energy)	Do not mix it into the Azure storyboard unless labeled

Architecture B — three tiles, three questions

Question	Pin this	Do not pin
Are we up?	Availability test result or App Insights availability	A VM CPU chart as a proxy for 'the website works'
Are we erroring?	Failed requests / exceptions	A green empty Failures blade labeled 'healthy' when the SDK is dark
Are we spending by accident?	Cost by RG or the lab RG sparkline	A fictional savings percentage
Need a guided investigation?	Workbook with a time parameter	Twelve more dashboard tiles instead of a workbook step

Architecture C — pitfalls that turn a glance into a novel

Pitfall	What you see	Fix
30-min explanation required	Stakeholders glaze over	Cut to three tiles. Workbook for the tour
Screenshot-as-tile	Stale PNG, looks official	Pin from the blade so it queries
Shared too widely	Lab telemetry + maybe a secret in a query	Myself only. Review pins for secret names
No data, fake green	Empty = healthy folklore	Tile subtitle 'no data yet' or fix Day 73 traffic
Every metric you know	Novel	If you cannot name the question, delete the tile

One-liner to remember

A dashboard is a storyboard — if it needs a 30-minute explanation, it is a novel, not a dashboard. Three tiles: up, erroring, spending. Share with yourself only.

Step-by-step lab (personal Azure / Azure DevOps only)

Personal Azure Portal. Dashboard visible to you only. Pin live charts from App Insights and Cost Management when you have them.

- 1 Portal → Dashboard → New. Name it azure-100-lab. Privacy: private / share with yourself only.

- 2 Pin tile 1 — availability (App Insights availability test or a metric that means 'up'). If you have no test, pin what you do have and label the gap.
- 3 Pin tile 2 — failures / failed requests. If empty because the app is dark, write 'no data yet' in the tile title rather than inventing healthy green.
- 4 Pin tile 3 — cost (Cost Management, lab RG). Even a small sparkline counts.
- 5 Open Workbooks in Monitor or App Insights. Peek at a template (parameters, steps). Do not paste a 12-step novel onto the dashboard. One sentence in the doc: workbook = guided ops, dashboard = glance.
- 6 Write docs/dashboard-day75.md: the three questions, share scope, and that Day 76 is pipeline analytics in Azure DevOps — a different storyboard.

Starter KQL for a workbook tile — requests by hour

```
requests
| where timestamp > ago(24h)
| summarize requests=count(), failed=countif(success == false) by bin(timestamp, 1h)
| render timechart
// Dashboard: Portal → Dashboard → New → pin Availability, Failures, Cost.
// Share: myself only. Workbooks = parameters + narrative; cut tiles before adding chapters.
```

Done checklist

- Dashboard with three tiles mapped to up / erroring / spending
- Shared with yourself only
- Empty data labeled honestly
- Knows workbook vs dashboard in one sentence

Tomorrow — Day 76

Pipeline monitoring and analytics — a red pipeline ignored for a week is a culture problem